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# PicknRead

*Africa's AI-Powered Reading, Listening & Watching Pipeline*

Investment Pitch Deck · 2026

## THE PROBLEM

# Africa reads — but rarely in its own languages, and rarely together.

### Readers

Native-language ebooks & audiobooks are scarce across major platforms; audiobook production is too expensive for most African-language titles to exist at all.

### Writers

Traditional publishing is slow, gatekept, and forces authors to manually repackage one book for every retailer.

### Community

Reading is a solitary retail transaction — no built-in way to discuss or share a book with other readers.

## THE SOLUTION

# One manuscript. Every format. Every major channel.

1

Native-language-first catalogue built for African readers and the diaspora.

2

AI production pipeline: one manuscript becomes an ebook, an AI-narrated audiobook, and short promotional “flicks” without re-keying content.

3

Community layer — reading circles, live events, a shorts feed — that pure retail platforms like Amazon don't offer.

# A young, mobile-first, underserved reading market.

## Mobile-first

African internet access is overwhelmingly smartphone-based — a natural fit for ebooks, audio, and short-form video over costly physical print distribution.

## Underserved languages

isiZulu, Afrikaans, Swahili, Yoruba, Amharic and more remain a tiny fraction of major retailers' catalogues.

## Three audiences

African readers & diaspora, independent African authors/publishers, and global readers seeking African storytelling via the same retail channels.

# A working platform, not just a plan.

- Categorised library with in-browser reader & saved progress
- In-browser AI-narrated audiobooks (voice & speed controls)
- Swipeable shorts feed with likes
- Reading circles with live chat + events calendar with RSVPs
- Flagship title “Before the Turmoil” live at launch

# Publish once. Distribute everywhere — automatically.

Amazon KDP

Lulu

IngramSpark

Apple Books

Google Play Books

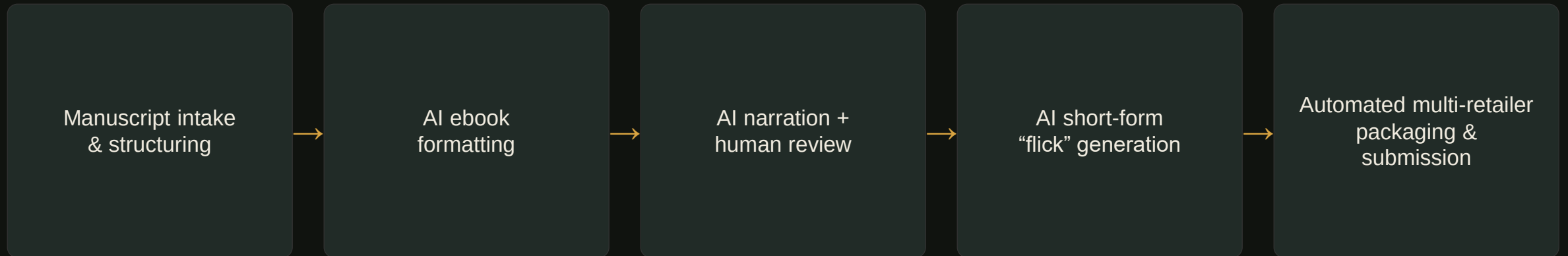
Blurb

BookBaby

PublishDrive

*Full cost & royalty modelling across every channel — with a live “best choice” calculator — in the companion spreadsheet.*

# A tested, repeatable AI production pipeline.



*Every stage has a validation checkpoint before a title moves forward — fast because it's reliable, not instead of reliable.*

# From live platform to owned infrastructure.

Now

Core platform, flagship title live across initial channels

Next 6 mo

Automated multi-channel pipeline complete; sleep & lullaby category launched

6–12 mo

Regional subscription pilot; expanded native-language catalogue; author tools

12–24 mo

Higgsfield short films integrated; self-hosting decision made from real usage data

# Risk management by design.

## Platform dependency

Multi-channel distribution — no single retailer is a point of failure

## AI content quality

Human editorial review at every pipeline checkpoint

## Infrastructure risk

Managed cloud + backups now; self-hosting only once cost/risk data justifies it

## Regional financial risk

Subscriptions & infra investment gated market-by-market on real analysis

## THE ASK

# Invest in the pipeline that publishes once, everywhere.

- Harden the automated multi-channel distribution pipeline
- Expand the native-language catalogue
- Launch the sleep & lullaby category
- Pilot regional subscriptions + Higgsfield short-film production

*Full financials, use-of-funds detail, and channel economics in the accompanying Business Plan and Cost & Royalty Comparison workbook.*